

Irina-Maria Ionita

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PROFILE

Early-career professional with a proactive attitude and experience in policy support, project coordination, and stakeholder engagement. Strong analytical and communication skills, eager to contribute to meaningful initiatives within an international setting

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

European Commission

Mar. 2026 – Present

Bluebook Trainee Directorate General for Justice and Consumers

- Supported the better regulation team with reviewing Terms of Reference and progress reports
- Coordinated a DG-wide screening exercise of expert groups, collecting inputs from across the DG
- Assisted in the management of access to documents requests

La Strada International (LSI)

Apr. 2024 – Feb. 2026

Researcher | March 2025 – February 2026

- Improved the annual data collection across 26 NGOs by redesigning the survey, creating a timeline and systematising the data gathering process
- Led a working group on the development of National Referral Mechanisms for victims of human trafficking across EU Member States
- Managed the implementation of a multi-partner project on [combating human trafficking for labour exploitation](#) by tracking the budget and timely submission of deliverables

Event Coordinator | July – September 2025

- Organised the [annual General Assembly](#) (40+ participants): managed the logistics budget, and the on-site coordination
- Wrote the activity and donor reports

Research Intern | April 2024 – Feb. 2025

- Conducted mixed-methods research (surveys and interviews) with 10 NGOs to inform policy recommendations on victim identification and protection.
- Co-authored 2 case assessment reports on regional anti-trafficking responses
- Developed a policy brief on the identification of victims of human trafficking, synthesising legal and policy findings into clear recommendations.

EDUCATION

Beijing International Chinese College

Feb. – Jun. 2025

- HSK 3 Chinese language course and cultural immersion programme

University of Amsterdam

- BSc Psychology, Social Psychology major
- LLM Public International Law
- BA European Studies, majors in European Law and Eastern European studies

Aug. 2020 – Jan. 2025

Aug. 2022 – Sept. 2025

Aug. 2019 – Sept. 2022

SKILLS

Organisation skills:

- *Strong planning and coordination skills*: ensuring the timely delivery of high-quality outputs for the Trafficked en Route project

Social and Interpersonal skills:

- *Ability to tailor communication* materials to target audiences and institutional priorities
- *Team engagement and cross-team cooperation*: worked across 3 different teams within Unit H1 of DG JUST
- *Conflict mediation and de-escalation*: mediated conflicts between clients and contractors for a year as a customer service agent

Quantitative and Qualitative Research and Analysis

- SPSS, JASP, Excel, interviewing, survey design and data visualisation in SPSS, JASP, Excel

Knowledge of Commission tools: Decide, GoPro, Sysper, EASE, Ares

LANGUAGES

- Romanian | native (C2)
- English | full professional proficiency (C2)
- French | limited working proficiency (B1)
- Italian | limited working proficiency (B1)
- Mandarin Chinese | limited working proficiency (B1)

PUBLICATIONS

- [Trafficking in Human Beings - Statistics and Trends \(2024\)](#)
- [Assisting Displaced Persons from Ukraine](#)
- [Trafficking in Human Beings – Statistics and Trends \(2023\)](#)
- [Assessment of the Principle of Non-Punishment](#)

ANCILLARY ACTIVITIES

Present LSI's Non-Punishment report at the UNODC Regional Expert Group Meeting on Forced Criminality (2025)